



WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Electronic Arts**, the video-game maker, is in advanced talks to go private in a roughly \$50 billion deal that would likely be the largest leveraged buyout of all time. **A1**
- ◆ **Many of the world's** richest drugmakers say they expect to be unscathed by Trump's plan for new tariffs on pharmaceuticals, but smaller biotech firms are a different story. **A2**
- ◆ **Federal regulators** are scaling back obstacles for Boeing to deliver some of its newly produced aircraft. **B9**
- ◆ **Sinclair and Nexstar** said they would end their preemption of "Jimmy Kimmel Live!" and air the show again beginning Friday. **B9**
- ◆ **Meta said British users** of Facebook and Instagram will have the option to pay for an ad-free service. **B9**
- ◆ **Jaguar Land Rover** has begun a gradual restart of its operations, following a cyber-attack on the automaker. **B9**
- ◆ **AstraZeneca said it** would offer its asthma and diabetes drugs at an up to 70% discount in the U.S. ahead of a Trump administration deadline. **B10**
- ◆ **The S&P 500 advanced** about 0.6% on Friday, while the Dow gained 0.7% and the Nasdaq added 0.4%. **B10**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Netanyahu struck** a defiant tone at the U.N., lashing out at countries that recognized a Palestinian state this past week amid a crescendo of international criticism over the country's conduct in the war in the Gaza Strip. **A1**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court** in a 6-3 order granted the Trump administration's emergency request to allow it to withhold \$4 billion in foreign-aid spending that had been approved by Congress. **A3**
- ◆ **President Trump told** Zelenskyy he was open to lifting restrictions on Kyiv's use of American-made long-range weapons to strike inside Russia, but he didn't commit to doing so during a meeting. **A7**
- ◆ **A Pentagon plan** to field thousands of cutting-edge drones to prepare for a potential conflict with China has fallen short of its goal. **A5**
- ◆ **Howard Rubin**, a former financier, was charged with trafficking dozens of women whom federal prosecutors said he sexually and physically assaulted during encounters in New York. **A5**
- ◆ **China's Li Qiang outlined** Beijing's plans to deepen its engagement with the United Nations in such sectors as AI and culture. **A7**
- ◆ **An autopsy found** the shooter who killed four people at a Midtown Manhattan office building had CTE. **A5**

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Charlie Kirk and the New Christian GOP **A13**

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Lashing out at countries that have recognized a Palestinian state, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu told the United Nations General Assembly, 'Instead of fighting the terrorists who murdered many of your citizens, you are fighting us.'

Netanyahu Says Israel's Critics 'Caved' to Pressure on Gaza War

By ANAT PELED AND FELIZ SOLOMON

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel struck a defiant tone at the United Nations on Friday, lashing out at countries that recognized a Palestinian state this week amid a crescendo of international criticism over the country's conduct in the war in the Gaza Strip.

Netanyahu, who has consistently pushed for tougher military action in the enclave, including a continuing operation to take over the key population center of Gaza City, accused his critics of turning against Israel under pressure from their domestic populations, rising antisemitism and a biased media.

"When the going got tough, you caved," he said in a speech to delegates at the U.N. General Assembly. "Instead of fighting the terrorists who murdered many of your citizens, you are fighting us."

Just before the speech began, a mass of delegates excited from the room. As a result, Netanyahu spoke to an almost empty assembly hall. Netanyahu said he ordered that loudspeaker trucks be deployed to Gaza, so that hostages could hear him as he called for them to be freed.

The Israeli prime minister is set to meet Monday with President Trump. The U.S. has been Israel's strongest source of support, particularly under Trump, but the president has been pushing Israel and Hamas to accept a cease-fire plan and has recently shown frustration with Netanyahu, including over Israel's strike on Hamas leadership.

◆ **Plan backs Tony Blair to lead postwar Gaza.....** **A8**

AI Spending Is at Epic Levels. Will It Ever Pay Off?

Tech companies pour hundreds of billions into data centers, taking on heavy debt, but current revenue is relatively tiny

By ELIOT BROWN AND ROBBIE WHELAN

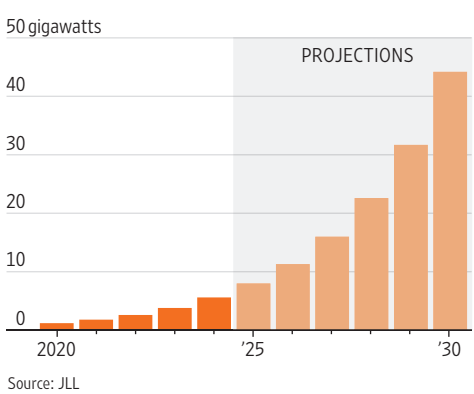
The windswept town of Ellendale, N.D., population 1,100, has two motels, a Dollar General, a Pentecostal Bible college—and a half-built AI factory bigger than 10 Home Depots.

Its more than \$15 billion price tag is equivalent to a quarter of the state's annual economic output.

The artificial-intelligence boom has ushered in one of the costliest building sprees in world history. Over the past three years, leading tech firms have committed more toward AI data centers like the one in Ellendale, plus chips and energy, than it cost to build the interstate

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Projected AI data center capacity, North America



Source: JLL

How to Make a Fan Base Mad: Take Away Their Pony

SMU tried to retire a popular rallying cry for its sports teams. It went badly.

By LAINE HIGGINS

David Miller might be the most beloved alum in Southern Methodist University's recent history.

The billionaire booster almost single-handedly resuscitated SMU's athletic department, which was busted for illegally paying players and rendered irrelevant for decades, and returned it to the national stage.

That all changed this month when he stepped in a steaming pile of horse you-know-what. "Pony Up," he declared of the university's

popular slogan, "has died a natural death."

He might as well have graffitied the Alamo.

Social media is awash with retaliatory "Pony Up" posts. Fans are protesting with signs at game day. The student government even passed an emergency measure to reinforce the sanctity of "Pony Up."

"Obviously he doesn't know a goddamn thing about marketing," SMU alum Greg Gaylor said of Miller. "To mess with something that works is the height of stupidity."

The university's mascot is

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Doubts Loom Over Tariff Impact on Manufacturing

By CHAO DENG

Economists cast doubt Friday on whether President Trump's plan to impose new tariffs on pharmaceuticals, large trucks and home goods would achieve his goal of reviving U.S. manufacturing and spurring the domestic production of patented drugs.

Trump, citing unfair competition from abroad, said late Thursday he planned a 100% tariff on any branded or patented pharmaceutical product unless the company is building a plant in the U.S.

Heavy trucks brought from outside the U.S. would be hit with a 25% tariff, he said, and 50% levies would be added to

certain household furnishings. A lot still remains unclear about how the tariffs would be implemented, but economists said they were uncertain whether these new tariffs would be enough to level the playing field.

In theory the notion makes sense: tariffs make goods from abroad more expensive for U.S. consumers, and rising prices should suppress consumer demand and make it easier for domestic producers to compete. This has been a

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◆ **New tariffs spare biggest drug makers.....** **A2**
◆ **EU aims to sign deals with 3 Asean nations.....** **A9**

Game Maker Explores Massive Buyout

Investors near a roughly \$50 billion deal to privatize Electronic Arts

Videogame maker Electronic Arts is in advanced talks to go private in a roughly \$50 billion deal that would likely be the largest leveraged buyout of all time, people familiar with the matter said.

By Lauren Thomas, Jessica Toonkel and Miriam Gottfried

A group of investors including private-equity firm Silver Lake, Saudi Arabia's Public Investment Fund and Jared Kushner's investment firm Affinity Partners could unveil a deal for the publisher best known for its sports games as soon as next week, the people said.

EA has long made games including FIFA, the soccer videogame now known as FC, and the football game Madden NFL, as well as The Sims and other titles.

The California company had a market value of about \$43 billion before The Wall Street Journal reported on the talks, which sent the stock up nearly 15% Friday. Its shares closed at \$193.35, a record high, giving the company a market value of about \$48 billion.

Discussions on price are under way, but the deal could value EA at as much as \$50 billion, two of the people said.

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Trump Overcame Dissent on Comey

WASHINGTON—President Trump asked advisers directly last week: Where were the prosecutions that he wanted to see?

By Sadie Gurman, Josh Dawsey and Aruna Viswanatha

He had been hearing from allies that his Justice Department wasn't moving aggressively against the people who had investigated and prosecuted him, according to people familiar with the matter. Chief among them: former Federal Bureau of Investigation Director James Comey.

Senior DOJ officials told

him the evidence against Comey wasn't a slam-dunk, and prosecutors in Virginia didn't want to bring the case. Other White House officials worried that such a case could end badly.

Trump told the DOJ officials to make the best case they could, officials said. He said any lack of evidence was just like what he faced in his own criminal cases, the people said.

On Thursday, Attorney General Pam Bondi delivered, extracting from a grand jury in

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◆ **Trump expects more of his foes to be indicted.....** **A6**

EXCHANGE



TYLENOL'S CRISIS
What it was like inside the company at the center of the storm **B1**